

SSC CGL TIER 2 • ENGLISH GRAMMAR SERIES

Subject–Verb Agreement

25 Advanced Practice MCQs | Questions and Answers

Each question is followed by its answer, with a clear explanation of the rule being tested — built for focused, exam-hall style practice.

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QUESTION 1 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

The committee ____ unanimous in its opinion regarding the new policy.

A is

B are

C were

D have

ANSWER — QUESTION 1 OF 25

The committee ____ unanimous in its opinion regarding the new policy.

✓ Correct Answer: **A) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

“Committee” is a collective noun. When it acts as a single unit — signalled here by “its opinion” — it takes a singular verb.

QUESTION 2 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Either the manager or the employees ____ responsible for the delay.

A is

B are

C was

D has been

ANSWER — QUESTION 2 OF 25

Either the manager or the employees ____ responsible for the delay.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) are**

RULE & EXPLANATION

With either...or, the verb agrees with the subject nearer to it. “Employees” (plural) is nearer, so the verb must be plural.

QUESTION 3 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Neither the players nor the coach ____ satisfied with the result.

A were

B are

C was

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 3 OF 25

Neither the players nor the coach ____ satisfied with the result.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) was**

RULE & EXPLANATION

With neither...nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject, “the coach” (singular) — so a singular verb is required.

QUESTION 4 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Each of the candidates ____ required to submit three photographs.

A are

B is

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 4 OF 25

Each of the candidates ____ required to submit three photographs.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

“Each” is always singular, regardless of the plural noun that follows it in the “of” phrase.

QUESTION 5 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Every teacher and student ____ invited to the annual function.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 5 OF 25

Every teacher and student ____ invited to the annual function.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

When “every” precedes a compound subject joined by “and,” the verb still remains singular.

QUESTION 6 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Everybody in the department ____ aware of the revised guidelines.

A are

B is

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 6 OF 25

Everybody in the department ____ aware of the revised guidelines.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

Indefinite pronouns such as everybody, everyone, somebody and nobody always take a singular verb.

QUESTION 7 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

A number of students ____ failed to submit their assignments on time.

A has

B is

C have

D was

ANSWER — QUESTION 7 OF 25

A number of students ____ failed to submit their assignments on time.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) have**

RULE & EXPLANATION

“A number of” means “many” and is treated as plural, so it takes a plural verb.

QUESTION 8 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

The number of unemployed youth in the state ____ increasing every year.

A are

B is

C were

D have

ANSWER — QUESTION 8 OF 25

The number of unemployed youth in the state ____ increasing every year.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

“The number of” refers to one specific figure and is treated as singular, taking a singular verb.

QUESTION 9 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Two-thirds of the students in the class ____ present for the seminar.

A was

B is

C were

D has been

ANSWER — QUESTION 9 OF 25

Two-thirds of the students in the class ___ present for the seminar.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) were**

RULE & EXPLANATION

With fractions, the verb agrees with the noun following “of.” Since “students” is plural, the verb must be plural.

QUESTION 10 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Three-fourths of the syllabus ____ already been completed.

A have

B has

C were

D are

ANSWER — QUESTION 10 OF 25

Three-fourths of the syllabus ___ already been completed.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) has**

RULE & EXPLANATION

Since "syllabus" (the noun after "of") is singular, the fraction takes a singular verb.

QUESTION 11 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Five kilometres ____ a long distance to walk every morning.

A are

B is

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 11 OF 25

Five kilometres ___ a long distance to walk every morning.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

When distance, money, weight or time is viewed as a single quantity, it takes a singular verb.

QUESTION 12 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

He is one of the boys who ____ selected for the state-level competition.

A has been

B is

C have been

D was

ANSWER — QUESTION 12 OF 25

He is one of the boys who ____ selected for the state-level competition.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) have been**

RULE & EXPLANATION

In “one of the + plural noun + who,” the relative pronoun “who” refers to “boys” (plural), so the verb must be plural.

QUESTION 13 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

There ___ several reasons behind his sudden resignation.

A is

B was

C are

D has been

ANSWER — QUESTION 13 OF 25

There ___ several reasons behind his sudden resignation.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) are**

RULE & EXPLANATION

In “there is/are” constructions, the verb agrees with the noun that follows it — here, “reasons” (plural).

QUESTION 14 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

The manager, along with his team members, ____ attending the seminar tomorrow.

A are

B is

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 14 OF 25

The manager, along with his team members, ___ attending the seminar tomorrow.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

Phrases like “along with,” “together with” and “as well as” do not change the subject’s number; the verb agrees only with “the manager” (singular).

QUESTION 15 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

The quality of the products manufactured here ____ improved significantly.

A have

B has

C were

D are

ANSWER — QUESTION 15 OF 25

The quality of the products manufactured here ___ improved significantly.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) has**

RULE & EXPLANATION

The verb must agree with the head noun “quality” (singular), not with “products,” which sits inside the intervening phrase.

QUESTION 16 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Swimming in the river during the monsoon ____ extremely dangerous.

A are

B is

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 16 OF 25

Swimming in the river during the monsoon ___ extremely dangerous.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

A gerund phrase functioning as the subject of a sentence is always treated as singular.

QUESTION 17 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

To complete the project within the deadline ____ our foremost priority.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 17 OF 25

To complete the project within the deadline ___ our foremost priority.

✓ Correct Answer: C) is

RULE & EXPLANATION

An infinitive phrase used as the subject of a sentence always takes a singular verb.

QUESTION 18 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Not only the students but also the teacher ____ appreciated for the initiative.

A were

B was

C have been

D are

ANSWER — QUESTION 18 OF 25

Not only the students but also the teacher ____ appreciated for the initiative.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) was**

RULE & EXPLANATION

With “not only...but also,” the verb agrees with the noun nearer to it — here, “the teacher” (singular).

QUESTION 19 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

It is essential that every candidate ____ present before 9 a.m. on the day of the exam.

A is

B was

C be

D will be

ANSWER — QUESTION 19 OF 25

It is essential that every candidate ____ present before 9 a.m. on the day of the exam.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) be**

RULE & EXPLANATION

In subjunctive constructions after phrases like “it is essential/necessary that,” the base form of the verb is used regardless of the subject.

QUESTION 20 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

None of the members ____ present at yesterday's meeting.

A was

B are

C were

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 20 OF 25

None of the members ____ present at yesterday's meeting.

✓ Correct Answer: **A) was**

RULE & EXPLANATION

In formal usage, “none” is treated as singular (meaning “not one”), so it takes a singular verb.

QUESTION 21 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

'Two States' ____ one of the most popular novels written by Chetan Bhagat.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 21 OF 25

'Two States' ____ one of the most popular novels written by Chetan Bhagat.

✓ Correct Answer: **C) is**

RULE & EXPLANATION

Titles of books, films and organisations are treated as singular, even if the title contains a plural noun.

QUESTION 22 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Many a soldier ____ sacrificed his life for the nation's freedom.

A have

B has

C were

D are

ANSWER — QUESTION 22 OF 25

Many a soldier ____ sacrificed his life for the nation's freedom.

✓ Correct Answer: **B) has**

RULE & EXPLANATION

In the construction “many a + singular noun,” the verb is always singular.

QUESTION 23 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

Mathematics ____ considered a difficult subject by many students.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 23 OF 25

Mathematics ___ considered a difficult subject by many students.

✓ Correct Answer: C) is

RULE & EXPLANATION

Certain nouns ending in “-s” (Mathematics, Physics, News, Economics) are singular in meaning and take a singular verb.

QUESTION 24 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

A pair of scissors ____ lying on the study table.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 24 OF 25

A pair of scissors ___ lying on the study table.

✓ Correct Answer: C) is

RULE & EXPLANATION

In “a pair of + plural noun,” the verb agrees with “pair” (singular), not with the plural noun that follows.

QUESTION 25 OF 25

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option:

More than one student ____absent from the class today.

A are

B were

C is

D have been

ANSWER — QUESTION 25 OF 25

More than one student ___ absent from the class today.

✓ Correct Answer: C) is

RULE & EXPLANATION

Despite sounding plural, “more than one + singular noun” conventionally takes a singular verb.

Practice makes precision.

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